# The Firm Inside Out

What Goldman Sachs actually is, how every pound of it is earned, which part loses money, why it is built the way it is, what the clients are really buying, and exactly where your seat sits in all of it.

Doc 30 · Built for requisition 171037: 2027 | EMEA | London | Asset Management, Client Solutions Group | Summer Analyst · Financials from the Q3 2026 earnings release and the September 2026 Form 10-Q · Prepared 3 November 2026

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**How to read this.** Every financial figure marked PRIMARY comes from Goldman's own Q3 2026 earnings release of 13 October 2026 or its Form 10-Q for the period ended 30 September 2026, which I downloaded and read directly. Figures marked MEDIUM come from reputable secondary sources. Figures marked LOW rest on one weak source and should not be said out loud without checking. Where I do not know something, I say so rather than filling the gap.

PART I

## The machine

## 1 The one-paragraph answer

If you learn one paragraph from this document, learn this one.

> Goldman Sachs is a firm that gets paid for standing between people who have capital and people who need it. It does that in four distinct ways: it **advises** on transactions and gets a fee; it **intermediates** markets, taking the other side of client trades and earning the spread; it **finances** clients using its own balance sheet and earns the spread on that lending; and it **manages money** for clients and takes a percentage of it every year. The first two are episodic and depend on market activity. The second two are durable and arrive whether markets are busy or not. The entire strategy of the firm for the last five years has been to grow the durable half, because investors pay a higher multiple for revenue that shows up every quarter.

Everything else in this report is detail hanging off that paragraph. If you can say it in your own words, you are already ahead of almost every candidate, because most of them will describe the firm by its *divisions*, which is an org chart, not a business model.

| $18.7bn | $5.29bn | 18.7% | $4.10tn | 47,500 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 NET REVENUES | Q3 2026 NET EARNINGS | ANNUALISED ROE | ASSETS UNDER SUPERVISION | HEADCOUNT |

All five figures as at or for the quarter ended 30 September 2026. PRIMARY

## 2 Seven decisions that made the firm think the way it thinks

You asked for history so you could understand the firm's mind. Dates alone will not do that. What follows are seven moments where the firm made a choice, and each choice is still visible in how it behaves today. That is the useful version of history.

### 1869 — Marcus Goldman starts discounting commercial paper

A German immigrant in a one-room office in Lower Manhattan buys merchants' IOUs at a discount and sells them on to banks. Son-in-law Samuel Sachs joins in 1882. WELL ESTABLISHED

**Why it still matters:** the firm's original business was *intermediation*, not lending and not advice. It made money by standing in the middle and being trusted by both sides. That is still the core instinct, and it is why the firm is culturally more comfortable as an intermediary than as a principal.

### 1956 — Sidney Weinberg takes Ford public

Weinberg, who joined as a janitor's assistant, spent years cultivating the Ford family and won what was then the largest IPO in history.

**Why it still matters:** this is the origin of the firm's central belief that *relationships compound and are the asset*. Not the product, not the technology: the relationship. Which is why a client-facing role in this firm is treated as a career, not a stepping stone, and why "coverage" is a prestigious word internally.

### 1970 — Penn Central collapses

Goldman sold Penn Central commercial paper to clients shortly before it went bankrupt, and faced years of litigation and reputational damage.

**Why it still matters:** this is the scar tissue behind the obsession with suitability, disclosure and documentation. When you later work on a due diligence questionnaire and wonder why the process is so heavy, this is the ancestor of that process.

### 1979 — John Whitehead writes the Business Principles

Fourteen numbered principles, the first of which is "Our clients' interests always come first." They are still printed, still quoted internally, and still the language senior people reach for.

**Why it still matters:** the firm deliberately wrote its culture down rather than leaving it to be absorbed. That tells you something about how seriously it treats cultural transmission, and it is why "apprenticeship" appears unironically in the division description of the job you applied for.

### 1999 — The partnership goes public

After decades of debate, Goldman lists on the NYSE. WELL ESTABLISHED

**Why it still matters:** this is the single most consequential decision in the firm's modern history, and it created the tension that defines it today. As a partnership, the people who took the risk owned the firm and the capital was theirs. As a public company, the capital belongs to shareholders who want a return on it every quarter. Almost every strategic argument inside Goldman since 1999 is a version of this tension. The partnership title survives, and it still carries enormous weight, but the economics changed permanently.

### 2008 — Becoming a bank holding company

In the crisis, Goldman converted to a bank holding company, took a $5bn investment from Berkshire Hathaway, and came under Federal Reserve supervision. In 2010 it settled SEC charges over the Abacus CDO for $550m, then the largest SEC penalty against a Wall Street firm. MEDIUM — the $550m figure is well established in my knowledge but I could not re-verify it in today's research; check before quoting

**Why it still matters:** this is where capital regulation entered the firm's bloodstream. Every business now has to justify the capital it consumes. When you later read that Global Banking & Markets uses 89% of the balance sheet, the reason anyone cares is the regime that started here. It is also the origin of the deposit-funded businesses, because a bank holding company can take deposits, and deposits are cheap funding.

### 2016 to 2026 — The consumer detour, and the retreat

Goldman launched Marcus in 2016 and the Apple Card in 2019, attempting to build a mass-market consumer bank. It did not work economically. The credit card portfolio was transferred to held-for-sale in the fourth quarter of 2025, and the residual still shows up as losses today. PRIMARY — the held-for-sale transfer and the resulting markdowns are stated in the Q3 2026 release In parallel, the firm reorganised into three reporting segments and refocused on asset management, wealth management and financing.

**Why it still matters:** this is the most useful piece of history you have, because it is the only recent episode where the firm publicly got something wrong and then corrected. It is the origin of the current strategy. If somebody asks you what the firm has learned recently, the honest answer is: that it is extraordinarily good at serving institutions and wealthy individuals, and that it has no particular advantage in serving everybody else. The pivot back to durable institutional fee revenue is the direct consequence, and it is why your division is where the growth capital is going.

> **THINK LIKE THE CEO**
>
> A reader of articles says "Goldman exited consumer because Marcus lost money." A person who understands the firm says: "The consumer business was an attempt to buy revenue durability, which is what the equity market was asking for. It failed, so the firm went and bought durability somewhere it actually has an edge instead: fee-based asset management and balance-sheet financing for institutions. Same strategic goal, different route." That is the same fact, read as a strategy rather than an event.

## 3 How the firm is broken down, and why those three

Since the 2022 reorganisation there are three reporting segments. Not four, not nine. Learn the shape before the numbers.




Figure 1 — The firm, from the holding company down to your requisition. All figures Q3 2026. PRIMARY

### Why these three and not some other cut

This is the kind of question that separates understanding from recitation. The segments are not drawn by product. They are drawn by **how the business consumes capital and how the revenue behaves.**

- **Global Banking & Markets** is everything that needs a large balance sheet and a risk appetite. Advice technically does not, but it is bundled here because advisory relationships and markets relationships are the same relationships, and separating them would mean two people calling the same CFO.
- **Asset & Wealth Management** is everything that earns a percentage of someone else's money. It is capital-light by comparison and its revenue recurs.
- **Platform Solutions** is, honestly, a holding pen. It contains transaction banking plus the remains of the consumer experiment. Putting it in its own segment made the losses visible and separable, which is exactly what you do with something you intend to shrink or sell.

> **THINK LIKE THE CEO**
>
> Reporting segments are a *communication* decision as much as an operational one. Carving Platform Solutions out meant analysts could see the core franchise cleanly without consumer losses blurring it, and it created public accountability for fixing or exiting it. When a firm reorganises its segments, always ask what it now wants you to be able to see.

## 4 The complete money map

This is the heart of the document. Every revenue line the firm reports, what it actually is in plain English, and the Q3 2026 number. Learn this table and you know how the firm makes money better than most people who work there.

| Revenue line | Q3 2026 $m | What it actually is, assuming you know nothing |
|---|---|---|
| **GLOBAL BANKING & MARKETS — $13,458m** | | |
| **Advisory** | 1,654 | A company wants to buy, sell or merge with another company. Goldman advises on price, structure and tactics, and takes a fee on completion. The fee is a percentage of the deal, so it is huge per transaction and totally unpredictable. Paid on closing, which is why the "backlog" matters. |
| **Equity underwriting** | 666 | A company wants to sell shares to the public (an IPO) or sell more shares it already has listed. Goldman organises it, finds the buyers, prices it, and takes a cut of the money raised. |
| **Debt underwriting** | 904 | Same thing with borrowing. A company or government wants to issue bonds. Goldman arranges and distributes them for a fee. |
| **FICC intermediation** | 2,264 | FICC is Fixed Income, Currency and Commodities. "Intermediation" means market-making: a client wants to buy or sell a bond, a currency or an oil contract, and Goldman takes the other side of that trade immediately out of its own book, then manages the resulting risk. It earns the bid-offer spread. The client gets to transact right now at a known price, which is the service being sold. |
| **FICC financing** | 1,207 | Lending against fixed-income assets. Repo, mortgage lending, structured lending. A client owns bonds and wants cash without selling them, so Goldman lends against them and earns the spread. Boring, repeatable, balance-sheet-heavy. |
| **Equities intermediation** | 3,076 | The same market-making function in shares and equity derivatives. Up sharply this quarter, driven by derivatives. |
| **Equities financing** | 3,365 | **Read this one twice.** This is prime brokerage and portfolio financing: lending to hedge funds so they can run positions larger than their own capital, lending them the shares to sell short, and holding their assets. It is the single largest revenue line in the entire firm this quarter. It is also the most under-appreciated by outsiders. |
| **Other** | 322 | Mostly transaction banking revenue attributed here, plus residual items. |
| **ASSET & WEALTH MANAGEMENT — $5,051m** | | |
| **Management and other fees** | 3,587 | The core asset management business. A client gives Goldman money to manage, and Goldman charges an annual percentage of it. If the fee is 0.40% and the mandate is £1bn, that is £4m a year, every year, arriving in twelfths. This is the most prized revenue in the firm because it is almost entirely predictable. **This is the line your role feeds.** |
| **Incentive fees** | 587 | Performance fees. Mostly from private funds, paid when a fund returns more than an agreed hurdle, and often only when investments are actually sold and cash is returned. Lumpy by nature: this quarter's increase was driven by fund distributions. |
| **Private banking and lending** | 827 | Net interest income from wealthy clients' deposits and loans. Goldman takes deposits at one rate and lends at a higher one, keeping the difference. Also includes what remains of Marcus deposits. |
| **Investments** | 50 | Gains and losses on money the firm has invested off its own balance sheet in equity and debt positions. Deliberately being shrunk, which is why it is tiny. It was $342m a year earlier; the fall this quarter reflects markdowns in debt investments. |
| **PLATFORM SOLUTIONS — $170m** | | |
| **Platform Solutions** | 170 | Transaction banking (cash management and payments for corporate clients) plus the wind-down of consumer lending. Revenue fell 72% year on year because of markdowns on the Apple Card loan portfolio, which was moved to held-for-sale in Q4 2025. |
| **Firm total** | **18,679** | **Net revenues, three months ended 30 September 2026.** |

All figures from the Q3 2026 earnings release and the September 2026 Form 10-Q. PRIMARY

### The four engines, simplified

Collapse those twelve lines into the four ways the firm gets paid, and the business model becomes visible.

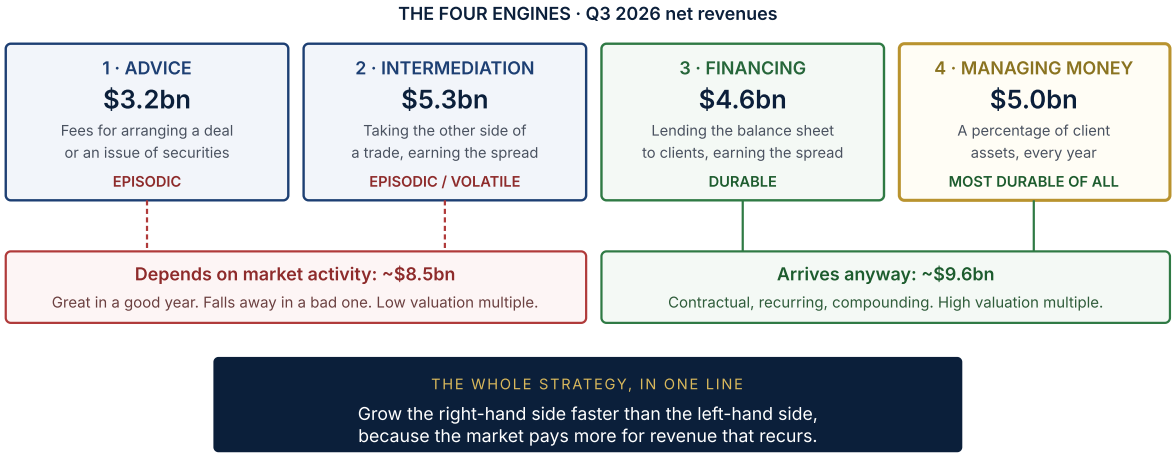



Figure 2 — The four engines. Sub-totals are my groupings of the reported lines, not a Goldman disclosure; the underlying line items are primary.

Note what this reveals. The firm's two *largest* single revenue lines this quarter were Equities financing ($3,365m) and Management and other fees ($3,587m). Neither of them is dealmaking. The popular image of Goldman is a firm of M&A bankers; the actual firm earns more from lending to hedge funds and from charging pension funds a percentage than it does from advising on takeovers. Saying that out loud, with the numbers, is the single most efficient way to prove you have looked past the brochure.

## 5 Does any division lose money? Yes. Here it is.

You asked directly, so here is the precise answer, from the segment note of the 10-Q rather than from commentary.

| Three months ended 30 Sept 2026, $m | Global Banking & Markets | Asset & Wealth Management | Platform Solutions | Firm |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Net revenues | 13,458 | 5,051 | 170 | 18,679 |
| Provision for credit losses | 345 | 23 | — | 368 |
| Compensation and benefits | 2,899 | 2,151 | 72 | 5,122 |
| Other operating expenses | 4,432 | 1,561 | 193 | 6,186 |
| Total operating expenses | 7,331 | 3,712 | 265 | 11,308 |
| **Pre-tax earnings / (loss)** | **5,782** | **1,316** | **(95)** | **7,003** |
| Average common equity | 81,485 | 24,427 | 3,468 | 109,380 |
| **Return on average common equity** | **20.7%** | **16.1%** | **(9.2)%** | **18.7%** |

Nine months to 30 September 2026: GBM pre-tax $18,762m (ROE 23.5%); AWM pre-tax $3,358m (ROE 14.4%, pre-tax margin 24%); Platform Solutions pre-tax loss $(68)m (ROE −2.7%); firm pre-tax $22,052m (ROE 20.7%). **PRIMARY — Form 10-Q, September 2026, segment note**

**So: Platform Solutions loses money.** It lost $95m pre-tax in the quarter and $68m across the nine months, on a return on equity of −9.2% and −2.7% respectively. The cause is explicitly stated: net markdowns on the Apple Card loan portfolio, which was transferred to held-for-sale in the fourth quarter of 2025. In other words, the loss is the *cost of exiting*, not the cost of operating. That distinction is the whole point.

> **WHAT THE HONEST READING IS**
>
> Three things are simultaneously true and a good answer holds all three. First, the loss is small: $95m against firm pre-tax earnings of $7.0bn, so it is about 1.4% of profit. Second, it is deliberate and finite, because you take markdowns when you sell something, and the firm has said it is selling. Third, it still matters, because it consumes $3.5bn of equity that would earn around 20% in Global Banking & Markets, and that opportunity cost is the real argument for exiting faster. The naive take is "a division is losing money, that's bad." The adult take is "the drag is small and intentional, and the live question is the capital trapped in it, not the headline loss."

### And the one your friend was half-right about

Asset & Wealth Management makes money, clearly and growingly: $1,316m pre-tax in the quarter, a 24% pre-tax margin for the nine months. But look at the ROE column. AWM returned 16.1% in the quarter against Global Banking & Markets at 20.7%, and for the nine months the gap is wider: 14.4% against 23.5%. **AWM is less profitable per pound of equity than the markets business.** That is the kernel of truth

inside the "asset management loses money" claim, which as stated is simply false. The reason the firm invests in AWM anyway is not margin, it is *durability* and the valuation multiple that comes with it.

## 6 Who actually uses the balance sheet

This is the single most revealing table in the 10-Q and almost nobody outside the firm looks at it.




Figure 3 — Segment assets. Percentages are my calculation from the primary figures: GBM $1,939,612m, AWM $210,899m, Platform Solutions $29,915m, total $2,180,426m. **PRIMARY**

Hold both halves of that in your head. Global Banking & Markets is a *capital-intensive* business: it needs an enormous balance sheet to make markets and to finance clients, and its profit scales with how much risk-weighted capital the regulator lets it hold. Asset & Wealth Management is a *people-intensive* business: it needs almost no balance sheet, and its profit scales with assets under supervision and headcount quality.

That difference explains more internal behaviour than any culture statement. It explains why AWM can grow without asking the regulator for anything, why AWM revenue is worth a higher multiple to shareholders, and why the firm would rather have a fee stream than an investment gain. It also explains why the firm has been shrinking the "Investments" line in AWM: that line uses the firm's own capital, and the strategy is to use clients' capital instead and charge a fee on it.

> **THINK LIKE THE CEO**
>
> You have roughly $110bn of common equity and shareholders expect a high-teens return on it. Every pound is contested. A pound in Equities financing is currently earning well above 20%. A pound in Platform Solutions is earning minus 9%. A pound in asset management earns less than markets but earns it more reliably, and reliability is what raises the price of the whole company. Your job as CEO is not to maximise revenue; it is to allocate that equity. Once you see the firm as a capital allocation problem, every strategic announcement becomes legible.

## 7 Durable versus episodic: the firm's actual thesis

This is the frame senior management uses, in their own words. From the Q3 2026 earnings call on 13 October 2026:
**MEDIUM — via a transcript aggregator, not Goldman's own posting**

> "We have created a higher revenue base with our more durable revenues having more than doubled since 2020 Investor Day."
>
> David Solomon, Chairman and CEO

> "Financing activities have become a larger and more durable component of our markets businesses."
>
> David Solomon

> "Demand for Equities financing continues to exceed available industry capacity, supporting attractive pricing."
>
> Denis Coleman, Chief Financial Officer

Read those three sentences together and the strategy is complete. The firm has concluded that its two routes to durable revenue are **financing** (lending its balance sheet to institutional investors, where demand currently exceeds industry capacity, which is a polite way of saying pricing power) and **fees on managed assets**. Everything else is the cyclical part of the business that pays very well in good years and cannot be relied upon.

### What that means for your division, concretely

The growth numbers management chose to highlight are all in Asset & Wealth Management: **MEDIUM**

- Alternatives fundraising of $37bn in the quarter and $122bn year to date, with the full-year target raised to roughly $150bn. It started the year at $75bn to $100bn, so the target has been raised twice.
- Alternative assets under supervision up 26% year on year to a record $491bn, against a stated goal of $750bn by 2030.
- Management and other fees up 22% year on year to a record $3.6bn in the quarter.
- Wealth Management long-term net inflows annualising at 12%, against a 5% target.
- Acquisitions used to buy capability: Innovator Capital Management brought $31bn of equity inflows, and the NEOS acquisition is expected to take global active ETF assets above $90bn.

And the assets-under-supervision picture from the 10-Q, which is primary: PRIMARY

| Assets under supervision, $bn, as at 30 Sept | 2026 | 2025 | What this tells you |
|---|---|---|---|
| Alternative investments | 491 | 390 | The highest-fee category and the fastest growing. Up 26%. |
| Equity | 1,150 | 914 | Boosted by market levels and by the Innovator acquisition. |
| Fixed income | 1,405 | 1,297 | The largest single block. Where the pension and insurance money sits. |
| **Total long-term AUS** | **3,046** | **2,601** | **The fee-earning core.** |
| Liquidity products | 1,051 | 851 | Money market funds and private bank deposits. Low fee, high volume. |
| **Total AUS** | **4,097** | **3,452** | **Grew $645bn in a year.** |

> **THINK LIKE THE CEO**
>
> Not all assets under supervision are equal, and treating the $4.1tn as one number is the mistake an outsider makes. A pound in alternatives might earn ten or more times the fee of a pound in a money market fund. So the mix matters more than the total: alternatives grew 26% while the total grew 19%, which means the revenue grew faster than the assets. That is why management leads with the alternatives number. If you ever want to sound like you understand an asset manager, ask about fee rate and mix before you ask about assets.

PART II

# The clients

## 8 Who the clients actually are

The firm's own one-sentence description, from the Q3 release: *"a large and diversified client base that includes corporations, financial institutions, governments and individuals."* PRIMARY That is accurate and useless. Here is the useful version, by segment.

| Segment | Who the client is | What they are actually buying |
|---|---|---|
| **Global Banking** | Companies, private equity sponsors, governments and state entities. The buyer is usually a CEO, CFO, treasurer or deal partner. | Judgement on a decision they will make once and cannot undo. The deliverable is advice; the fee is for being right and for being able to execute. |
| **Global Markets** | Asset managers, hedge funds, pension funds, insurers, central banks, corporates hedging exposures. The buyer is a portfolio manager, a trader or a treasurer. | Immediacy and capacity. The ability to buy or sell size right now at a known price, and the ability to borrow against a portfolio. They are buying liquidity and leverage. |
| **Asset Management** your side | Pension plans, sovereign wealth funds, insurance companies, endowments, foundations, financial institutions, governments, and third-party distributors and advisers who sell on to their own clients. | Investment outcomes they cannot produce in-house, and the governance comfort of having a credible institution responsible for them. |
| **Wealth Management** | Ultra-high-net-worth and high-net-worth individuals and families, plus the advisers who serve them. | A single place where a complicated personal balance sheet is managed, financed and planned for across generations. |
| **Platform Solutions** | Corporate treasurers (transaction banking) and the legacy consumer base. | Payments and cash management plumbing. |

## The number that tells you where you would sit

The 10-Q breaks long-term assets under supervision down by client channel. This is the most directly relevant table in the entire filing to the job you applied for. **PRIMARY**

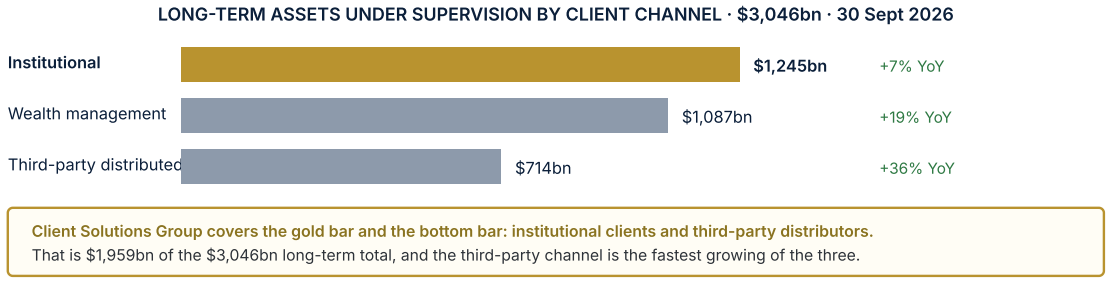



Figure 4 — Client channels. Year-on-year percentages are my calculation from the primary 2026 and 2025 figures. The channel-to-CSG mapping is my inference from job postings, not a Goldman disclosure. **MEDIUM on the mapping**

## 9 The five problems institutional clients actually have

You asked the right question: *what are the problems the clients have, and what's in it for them?* Marketing language describes products. Clients experience problems. Here are the five real ones, stated the way the client would state them.

### Problem 1 — "I have promised money to people in 2055 and I do not know if I will have it."

A defined benefit pension scheme owes specific payments decades into the future. Those promises are valued by discounting them at a market interest rate, so *the size of the debt moves every day with the bond market* even though nothing about the promises changed. The trustee's nightmare is that the liabilities grow faster than the assets.

**What Goldman sells into it:** liability-driven investing. A portfolio built so that when the liability value moves, the assets move the same way, which holds the funding level still. Long-dated bonds and interest rate swaps are the instruments. The client is not buying returns here; they are buying the removal of a specific risk.

**What's in it for the client:** the sponsor company's finance director stops having a surprise in the accounts every year.

### Problem 2 — "My investment team is four people and the world got complicated."

A corporate pension scheme with £5bn and four staff is now expected to have views on private credit, infrastructure, collateral management and currency hedging. It cannot hire twenty specialists. And if one of the four leaves, institutional memory walks out with them.

**What Goldman sells into it:** OCIO, the outsourced chief investment officer. The client hands over day-to-day investment decision-making for the whole portfolio, not just one mandate, within a strategy the trustees set and monitor. In some cases the client's in-house team physically transfers across, which is called a lift-out.

**What's in it for the client:** they rent an entire investment department, with a named accountable institution behind it, for less than building one. And the key-person risk becomes someone else's problem.

The scale of this: Goldman reported $480bn of OCIO assets under supervision as at 31 March 2026, and in July 2026 was appointed OCIO by Verizon and Lockheed Martin across more than $70bn of retirement assets. MEDIUM Earlier mandates include UPS at around $43bn and Shell at around $40bn, and the BAE Systems lift-out at roughly £23bn is the largest UK OCIO mandate on record. MEDIUM

### Problem 3 — "I need to own things that are not traded, and I cannot get access."

Returns from public markets are widely available and heavily competed. An insurer or sovereign fund wanting private credit, infrastructure or private equity cannot simply buy it on an exchange: it has to be originated, underwritten and structured by somebody with deal flow.

**What Goldman sells into it:** access to origination. The firm's banking relationships generate private deals, and the asset management arm packages them into funds and separate accounts that institutions can invest in. This is where the firm's two halves genuinely reinforce each other, and it is the reason alternatives fundraising is running at roughly $150bn a year.

**What's in it for the client:** a return stream their competitors cannot easily replicate, plus a diligence process they could not run themselves.

### Problem 4 — "I need to be able to defend this decision to my board."

This is the problem nobody writes brochures about and it may be the most important one. An institutional allocator is an agent. They are spending other people's money and they will be asked, possibly in public, why they chose what they chose. A decision that performs adequately and is defensible beats a decision that might perform better but cannot be justified if it goes wrong.

**What Goldman sells into it:** institutional credibility, documentation, reporting, and the ability to put a senior person in a board room who can explain the portfolio. This is what all the apparently bureaucratic process is actually for. The due diligence questionnaire is not red tape; it is the artefact the trustee files so that the decision is defensible for a decade.

**What's in it for the client:** career safety and governance comfort. A real and legitimate need.

> **WHY THIS ONE MATTERS TO YOU PERSONALLY**
>
> You built a DDQ portal at Pictet, tracking roughly 400 lines across 20 teams. Most candidates would describe that as administrative work. It is not. It is the production of the artefact that makes a client's decision defensible, which is one of the five things institutional clients are actually buying. If you can say that, you have reframed your own experience from "I did operations" to "I worked on the thing clients need in order to be able to say yes." That is a genuinely strong and completely honest reframe, and it is unavailable to anyone who did not do the work.

### Problem 5 — "I suddenly have a surplus and I do not know what to do with it."

The newest problem, and a good one to know. Higher interest rates cut the present value of pension liabilities, so UK defined benefit schemes went from widespread deficit to widespread surplus. The question changed from "how do we close the gap" to "do we buy out, or run on and use the surplus?" That is a harder question requiring more investment sophistication, not less.

**What Goldman sells into it:** advice on the endgame, and the investment capability to run on if that is the choice. Commercially this matters enormously: a buyout *ends* the asset management relationship, while running on extends it for decades.

## 10 Why clients come to Goldman rather than someone else

Be careful here, because this is where candidates recite. The honest competitive answer has four parts and one of them is not flattering.

1. **Breadth with one point of contact.** Very few firms can do public markets, private markets, liquidity management, financing and advice, and present them through one relationship. For a client with six problems, one accountable counterparty is genuinely cheaper and simpler than six specialists. This is the real content of "One Goldman Sachs."
2. **Origination the client cannot replicate.** Private deals come from relationships with companies. Goldman has those relationships because of the banking franchise. A pure asset manager has to buy its way into deals that someone else originated.
3. **Institutional cover.** See problem 4. The brand is not vanity for the client; it is defensibility.
4. **The unflattering one: price and performance are not always the reason.** Goldman is rarely the cheapest, and in plenty of individual strategies it is not the best performer. Clients often choose it despite those things, because of 1 to 3. Knowing that is what makes you credible rather than promotional.

> **WHERE GOLDMAN IS NOT THE OBVIOUS ANSWER**
>
> If you want to sound like an insider rather than an applicant, be able to say this. In plain-vanilla index tracking, Goldman is not the natural choice; scale players like BlackRock and Vanguard win on cost. In pure UK fiduciary management for small schemes, the consultant-descended firms have deeper distribution. And in several individual active strategies there are better single-strategy houses. Goldman's claim is not "best at everything"; it is "the broadest credible platform, delivered as one relationship." A candidate who can name the limits of their own firm's proposition sounds like someone who has sat in client meetings. A candidate who cannot sounds like someone who read the website.

PART III

# How the parts connect

## 11 How Asset Management actually works with Global Markets

You asked specifically about this and it is the right question, because it is where the firm's design becomes visible. The short answer: **Asset Management is one of Global Markets' largest customers, and the relationship is formally arm's-length.** Not a partnership, not a shared desk. A client relationship, with walls.

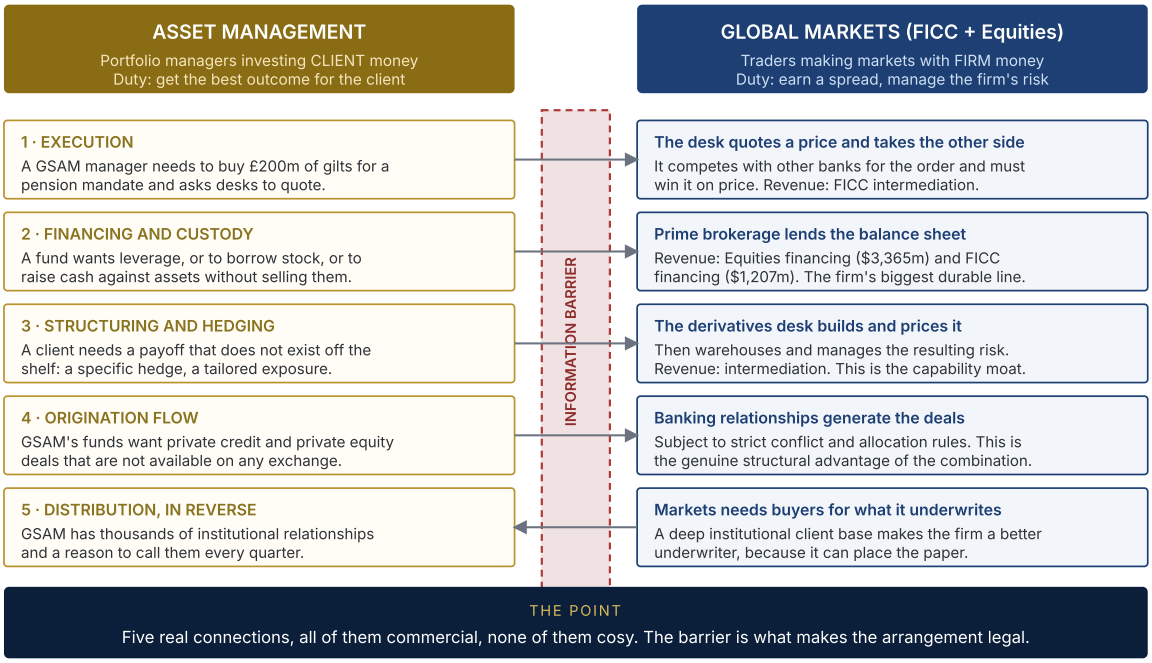



Figure 5 — The five real connections between Asset Management and Global Markets. Revenue lines are primary; the mapping of activity to line is my construction from the disclosures. **MEDIUM on the mapping**

## The part that matters most, and that candidates always miss

When GSAM asks a Goldman trading desk to quote, the desk does **not** get the order automatically. GSAM has a fiduciary duty to its clients to obtain best execution, which means it must shop the order and take the best price, even when the best price is at Morgan Stanley. The internal relationship is genuinely competitive, and that is a legal requirement rather than a cultural nicety.

This is why the information barrier in the diagram is drawn as a wall, not a bridge. The asset management side cannot know the firm's trading positions, and the trading side cannot know what GSAM is about to do for its clients. The firm derives real advantage from owning both halves, but the advantage is *structural* (origination, capability, distribution reach) rather than informational.

> **THINK LIKE THE CEO**
>
> Here is the tension you would live with. Owning both halves creates genuine synergies: deal flow for the funds, a distribution network for the underwriting business, a capability moat in structuring. It also creates conflicts that cost a fortune to police and that regulators scrutinise constantly. The firm has decided the synergies are worth the compliance cost. That is a judgement, not a law of nature, and the fact that other firms have chosen differently (pure asset managers, pure advisory boutiques) tells you it is contestable. Being able to articulate that trade-off, rather than just celebrating the synergy, is what an insider sounds like.

## 12 Why the firm is structured the way it is

Three reasons, in descending order of how much they actually drive the structure.

### REASON 1 — CAPITAL AND REGULATION

Since becoming a bank holding company, the firm's capacity to do business is bounded by capital rules. As at September 2026 its Common Equity Tier 1 ratio was 12.4% on the standardized approach, with risk-weighted assets of $817bn, and a supplementary leverage ratio of 4.3%. PRIMARY Businesses must therefore be organised in a way that lets management see, measure and move capital between them. That is why the segments are drawn along capital-intensity lines, and why segment assets and segment ROE are reported. You cannot allocate what you cannot see.

### REASON 2 — THE CLIENT SHOULD MEET ONE FIRM

A large institution might be an advisory client, a trading counterparty, a financing client and an asset management client simultaneously. If four unconnected teams call them, the firm looks incoherent and leaves money on the table. Grouping banking with markets means one coverage relationship for corporates; grouping asset with wealth management means one for allocators and families. Solomon's phrase for the effort to make this real across the whole firm is *"increased connectivity across the firm as we harness the power of One Goldman Sachs."* MEDIUM

### REASON 3 — TELLING THE EQUITY STORY

Investors value durable revenue more highly than volatile revenue. A structure that lets you say "this segment grew fees 22% and this other segment is the cyclical one" supports a higher valuation than one undifferentiated pile. Segment reporting is partly a disclosure strategy, and it is entirely legitimate to say so.

## 13 What One Goldman Sachs means in practice

Most candidates will say the phrase. Almost none will know what it operationally consists of. It is three things.

1. **Coverage coordination.** Knowing, firmwide, every relationship with a given client, and deciding who leads. Sounds trivial; in a firm of 47,500 people across three segments it is a hard data and governance problem.
2. **Consolidating competing internal teams.** Where the firm historically had two or three groups doing overlapping things and occasionally bidding against each other, the strategy has been to merge them so the client meets one platform. This is the thing you heard described in person at the private credit session.
3. **Cross-divisional delivery.** Bringing research, structuring, financing and investment capability to one client problem, and crucially agreeing internally how the revenue is credited, which is what actually determines whether people cooperate.

> **BE HONEST ABOUT THIS ONE**
>
> "One Goldman Sachs" is a real strategy and also a corporate slogan, and treating it as purely the former is how you sound naive. The honest position: it is a genuine attempt to solve a genuine problem, namely that a firm this broad will under-serve clients and duplicate effort unless somebody forces coordination. Whether it works depends on unglamorous things like how revenue is credited across divisions. If you say *that*, you sound like you have thought about incentives. If you say "I love the collaborative One Goldman Sachs culture," you sound like page three of the careers site.

PART IV

# The firm's character

## 14 The honest answer on the hours and the culture

You asked me to be honest about this, including whether the brutal conditions are what makes the firm. So here is the straight version, caveats and all.

## First, what is actually documented

In March 2021 a group of thirteen first-year analysts in Goldman's investment banking division compiled an internal survey. It reported average working weeks of roughly 95 to 100 hours, around five hours of sleep a night, and job satisfaction of about two out of ten; a large majority reported workplace abuse. It leaked and became a global news story. Goldman's response included raising junior salaries, committing to the "protected Saturday" policy, and hiring more juniors.

MEDIUM — the survey is well documented, but reported figures vary slightly between outlets and the exact numbers should be treated as approximate

I could find no equivalent 2026 survey, and I am not going to invent a current number. Later industry reporting suggests hours reverted substantially once the news cycle moved on, but that is commentary rather than evidence. LOW

## Second, and importantly: that was investment banking, not your division

This matters a great deal for your situation. The 100-hour culture is specifically an investment banking coverage and execution phenomenon, driven by live transactions with external deadlines set by clients, counterparties and regulators. A client-facing asset management seat is a different job with a different clock: it is driven by client meetings, reporting cycles, fundraising timetables and quarter-ends. The hours are real and the expectations are high, but the structural all-nighter is not the normal shape of the week. Treat anybody who tells you Goldman is uniformly a 100-hour firm as describing one division and generalising.

## Third, the actual question: is the hardness what makes the firm?

My honest answer is **no, and believing it does is the most common mistake smart applicants make.** The hardness is a symptom, not a cause. Here is what I think is actually going on, with the causes separated from the side effects.

| What people point at | What is actually happening |
|---|---|
| **"The brutal hours are the culture."** | Mostly a consequence of selling a service where the *client* sets the deadline, in a business with no inventory and no product to ship. If the client needs it Monday, somebody works the weekend. It is the economics of bespoke service work, not a deliberate hazing design. It is worse at Goldman than at many places partly because the firm takes on more consequential and more urgent mandates. |
| **"They only hire the best."** | This one is substantially real and it is a genuine cause. Extreme selectivity means the person next to you is unusually capable, which raises the standard of ordinary conversation, which is the actual mechanism by which people learn fast. The intensity people describe is as much peer standard as it is hours. |
| **"It's an apprenticeship."** | Also real, and it is written into the division description of the job you applied for. The firm transmits skill by proximity rather than by training programme. That is why juniors are in rooms they have not earned, and it is also why the hours are long: you cannot absorb by proximity from home at 4pm. |
| **"The partnership ethos."** | Residually real. The partnership title still exists and still carries weight, and it creates a long-horizon incentive at the top that most listed firms lack. But the firm has been public since 1999 and the capital belongs to shareholders. Anyone who describes Goldman as "still essentially a partnership" is romanticising. |
| **"The client-first principle."** | Genuinely load-bearing, and not for sentimental reasons. In a business with no patents and no factory, the only durable asset is being trusted with the next decision. Short-term extraction destroys that. Gus Levy's old phrase for this was being "long-term greedy," and it is the most honest description of the firm's self-interest I know. |

## Fourth: so what actually keeps someone going in the hard periods?

You asked this directly. The honest list, in the order I think it actually operates:

1. **The rate of learning is genuinely abnormal.** In a good seat you compress several years of ordinary professional development into one. People endure a lot for that, and it is the reason most commonly given that holds up.
2. **The people next to you.** Nearly everyone who stays says some version of this. Intensity shared with people you respect is tolerable; the same intensity alone is not. This is also why the firm invests so heavily in who it hires.
3. **Proximity to things that matter.** Being in the room when a £5bn decision is made is a real and non-financial reward.
4. **Specific clients and specific problems.** Over time the abstract motivation gets replaced by particular ones: this trustee board, this mandate, this problem you half-solved last quarter. People who last tend to be motivated by the next concrete thing rather than by the idea of the firm.
5. **Optionality afterwards.** Nobody says this in interviews. Everybody knows it. The years are an asset.
6. **Money.** It matters, it is a legitimate reason, and pretending otherwise is itself a tell. The rule is simple: do not lead with it and do not deny it.

**WHAT NOT TO SAY IN YOUR HIREVUE**

Do not say "I'm attracted to the hard-working culture" or "I thrive under pressure" or "I'm not afraid of long hours." Three reasons. Every single candidate says it, so it carries no information. It is unfalsifiable, so it is not an argument. And worst of all it signals that you think the job is an endurance test rather than a skilled one, which tells a reviewer you do not know what the work is. If you want to communicate the same thing, do it by describing something specific and hard you actually did, and let them draw the conclusion.

The same goes for reciting the Business Principles. "Our clients' interests always come first" is a line anybody can read off a page. What you can say, that almost nobody does, is *why* that principle is commercially rational in a business whose only asset is being trusted with the next decision. One is a quotation; the other is an argument.

PART V

# Your seat

## 15 Requisition 171037, decoded

I pulled your requisition directly from Goldman's applicant tracking system. Here is what is actually in it.

PRIMARY — queried live from the Oracle Recruiting Cloud API on 3 November 2026

| Field | Value |
|---|---|
| Requisition ID | **171037** |
| Title | 2027 \| EMEA \| London \| Asset Management, Client Solutions Group \| Summer Analyst |
| Category / type | Summer Analyst / Campus |
| Primary location | London, Greater London, England, United Kingdom |
| Posted | 15 August 2026 |
| Programme length | Nine to ten weeks |
| Number of openings | *Not disclosed in the requisition.* The field is empty. |
| Role-specific description | **There isn't one.** The requisition's description field is empty. All you get is a generic programme blurb and the Asset & Wealth Management division description. |
| Application cap | Up to four business/location combinations per recruiting year; additional applications are auto-withdrawn; creating extra email addresses is explicitly prohibited. |

**This is worth knowing, because it explains your confusion.** You are not failing to find the role description. It does not exist. Goldman's campus requisitions carry only the divisional text, identically across London, Hong Kong and everywhere else. I checked. So anyone who claims to know exactly what this internship involves from the posting is guessing. What follows is assembled from the division text, from other CSG job postings at experienced levels (which *do* carry descriptions), from the firm's own filings, and from what the business demonstrably does. I have labelled the inference throughout.

### The division text, which is the only official description you have

Here is what the requisition actually says about where you would work, verbatim: PRIMARY

> "Asset & Wealth Management (AWM) … We are committed to helping a diverse global client base—including mutual funds, hedge funds, pension plans, sovereign wealth funds, insurance companies, endowments, foundations, third-party wealth firms, and ultra-high-net-worth individuals—achieve their financial goals through strategic investment and advisory services. With over $3 trillion in assets under supervision, AWM delivers innovative solutions across traditional public investing and alternative investments…"
>
> "We emphasize an apprenticeship culture, enabling junior team members to learn directly from seasoned professionals."
>
> "Goldman Sachs Asset Management … As the primary investment area within Goldman Sachs, we offer investment and advisory services across public and private markets for pension plans, sovereign wealth funds, insurance companies, endowments, foundations, financial advisors, and individuals."
>
> Requisition 171037, OrganizationDescriptionStr field

Two things worth noticing. The client list is specific and it is the institutional list: pension plans and sovereign wealth funds come first, individuals come last. And the "$3 trillion" figure is the *long-term* assets under supervision number, now $3,046bn, not the headline $4.1tn. Someone writing that text chose the fee-earning number.

## 16 What Client Solutions Group actually is

In one sentence: **CSG is the client-facing half of Goldman Sachs Asset Management.** The investment teams manage the money. CSG owns the relationship with the people whose money it is and the intermediaries who distribute it.

Mapped onto the money map in section 4, that means CSG exists to grow and defend **Management and other fees**, the $3,587m line, of which the Asset Management half was $4,285m across the nine months. PRIMARY Every activity in the role traces back to that line: winning a new mandate adds to it, losing one subtracts from it, and moving a client from a low-fee product to a high-fee one raises it without changing the asset total at all.

### The sub-teams, as far as they are visible from the outside

Goldman does not publish a CSG org chart. These sub-units are named in CSG job postings at experienced levels, which is decent evidence that they exist but not evidence of how they relate to each other. MEDIUM — assembled from job postings, some 600 to 800 days old

| Sub-team | What it does, from the posting language |
|---|---|
| **Institutional coverage / sales** | Direct relationships with pension funds, insurers, sovereign wealth funds, endowments, foundations and governments. This is the classic CSG seat and the most likely home for a London summer analyst. |
| **Alternative Investment Solutions** | Sales, marketing and ongoing client support for private equity, private credit, real estate, liquid alternatives and hedge funds, distributed through third-party intermediaries. Given alternatives are growing 26% a year, this is where the energy is. |
| **Retirement Solutions** | Defined contribution, retirement intermediary and insurance business, plus a dedicated large-market retirement distribution effort. This is the team that wins mandates like Verizon's defined contribution assets. |
| **SMA sales and CIO consulting** | Separately managed accounts and chief investment officer consulting. Note that separate accounts are $2,180bn of the $4,097bn total, so this is the largest vehicle type in the business. |
| **Client Business Management** | Strategic projects affecting clients across all distribution channels and geographies. A horizontal function rather than a coverage one. |
| **Management & Strategy** | Financial modelling, strategic initiatives, business and financial reporting and data governance for CSG, partnering with AWM leadership, investing, operations, engineering, legal and compliance. The internal-facing engine room. |

### How many people? The honest answer

I could not find a reliable published figure for the size of CSG globally, in EMEA, or in London, and I am not going to estimate one and present it as a fact. What I can give you is what is actually knowable, which is more useful than a guess:

- **Firmwide headcount: 47,500** as at 30 September 2026, up 3% on the quarter because of campus hires. PRIMARY
- **Asset & Wealth Management compensation** was $2,151m in the quarter and $6,139m across nine months. PRIMARY That is the whole segment including wealth management and all the investment teams, so you cannot back out a CSG headcount from it, but it does tell you AWM carries a large share of the firm's people relative to its revenue: 42% of firmwide compensation on 27% of revenue.
- **London:**
- Published estimates for Goldman's London office range from about 3,615 (an industry estimate for early 2025) to around 6,000, and the UK total including Birmingham is reported at more than 6,000. These figures clearly measure different things and none is from Goldman. LOW — do not quote a London headcount as fact
- **EMEA scale, which you can state confidently:** EMEA produced $3,205m of net revenues in the quarter, 17% of the firm, and $11,474m across nine months, 20% of the firm, generating 22% of nine-month pre-tax earnings. PRIMARY And EMEA assets under supervision were $799bn of the $4,097bn total. PRIMARY Those are the right numbers to use when you want to say something about the London business, because they are real.

### Where CSG summer analysts are hired globally

This is a genuinely useful piece of intelligence and it comes straight from the requisition data. For the 2027 cycle, Asset Management Client Solutions summer analyst roles were posted in: **London** (171037), **Chicago** (155957), **Hong Kong** (171415), **Singapore** (171416), **Tokyo** (171419) and **Sydney** (155400), plus off-cycle CSG analyst roles in **Milan** (171032) and **Stockholm** (171034).
PRIMARY — from the requisition listing

What that tells you: CSG campus hiring is global but thin, roughly one posting per major financial centre, which is consistent with small teams hiring one or two analysts each. It also tells you London is the EMEA hub for this function, with Milan and Stockholm taking off-cycle rather than summer analysts.

## 17 What the job actually is, day to day

Assembled from the official description of the sales role, the sub-team postings, and what the business demonstrably has to do. **MEDIUM — this is a reconstruction, clearly flagged as such**

The official language for the sales seat is: marketing GSAM's products and services to institutions, financial intermediaries and advisers; "fostering and maintaining long-term client relationships" while "conveying key insights from Goldman Sachs' top investment professionals"; starting from "an in-depth understanding" of the investment strategies, then working "with industry experts and senior leaders to design and implement investment strategies" that fit client goals. **MEDIUM — careers-site derived**

Translated into things a human actually does, an analyst's week is mostly these six:

1. **Preparing for client meetings.** Building the materials: performance, positioning, attribution, the answer to the question the client asked last time. The senior person presents; the analyst makes the presentation possible and increasingly presents parts of it.
2. **Answering client questions that require somebody else's knowledge.** A trustee asks why the fund was underweight duration in September. The analyst goes to the portfolio manager, gets the answer, and translates it into something a non-specialist board can read. This is the actual skill of the job: translation in both directions.
3. **Due diligence questionnaires and RFPs.** When an institution considers a mandate, it sends a long structured questionnaire. Someone has to coordinate accurate answers from investment, risk, operations, legal and compliance, and get it back on time. *You have done exactly this.*
4. **Reporting and data.** Client reporting cycles, flows, mandate monitoring, keeping the record of what each client owns and wants straight.
5. **Pipeline and coverage work.** Tracking prospects, mandate searches, consultant relationships, who is reviewing what and when.
6. **Onboarding.** When a mandate is won, something has to be built: accounts opened, guidelines coded, market access arranged, counterparties set up. *You have done this too: fifty segregated market openings.*

### Who you would actually be talking to

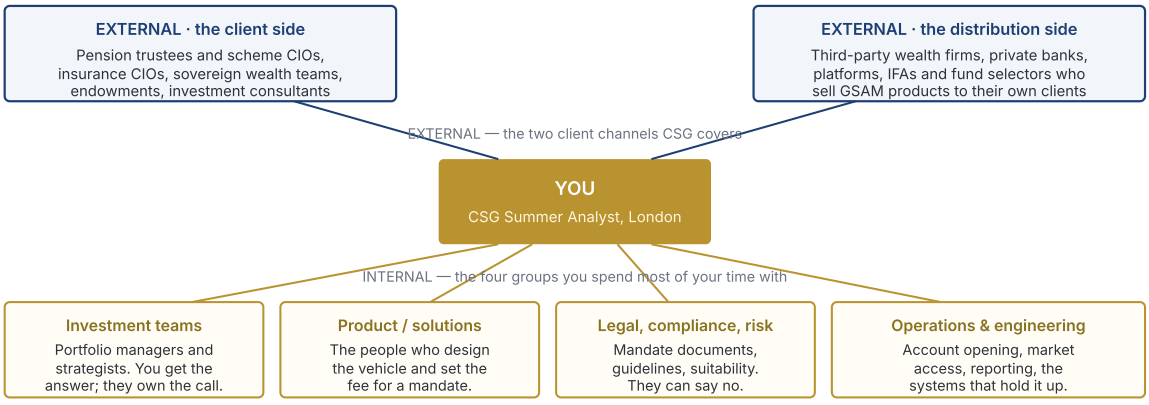



Figure 6 — The CSG analyst's actual network. Reconstructed from postings and the business's requirements. **MEDIUM**

Notice the shape of that diagram. You sit at the centre of six relationships and you have authority over none of them. You do not make the investment call, you do not set the fee, you cannot approve the document and you do not open the account. **What you own is the client's experience of the whole firm, and the only tool you have for it is the quality of your coordination.**

> THE ROLE IN ONE SENTENCE, WHICH IS WORTH MEMORISING
>
> Client Solutions Group exists to turn the firm's investment capability into something a specific institution can actually buy, hold, explain to its own board, and keep buying. The analyst's job is to make that possible by knowing the client's question, knowing who inside the firm has the answer, and closing the distance between them faster and more accurately than anyone else would.

## 18 Why firm, why role, why you

Here is how all of the above converts into the three questions. I am giving you the arguments and the evidence, not finished sentences, because finished sentences in your HireVue should be yours.

### Why Goldman — three arguments, pick two

1. **The structural one.** Goldman's asset management arm sits inside a firm that originates private deals, finances institutional investors and advises corporates. That means the investment capability you would be representing is partly manufactured by the firm itself rather than bought in the market. Evidence: alternatives assets under supervision up 26% year on year to a record $491bn, fundraising running at roughly $150bn a year. A pure asset manager cannot do that from a standing start.
2. **The strategic one.** The growth capital of the firm is going into this division on purpose, because the firm concluded after the consumer episode that durable fee revenue is where its real advantage lies. Evidence: management fees at a record $3.6bn, up 22%; $400bn of net inflows in nine months. You would be joining the part of the firm the firm itself is betting on.
3. **The personal one, which is yours alone.** You heard the integration argument made in person, by Ahmed on consolidating competing internal teams into one platform, and by Jack describing the client-facing seat as the conductor of the orchestra. You did not read that; you were in the room. Use it.

### Why this role

The honest, specific argument: you have already worked on the unglamorous machinery that makes institutional asset management actually function, and you liked it. Not in theory. Concretely:

- At Pictet's Global Client Group you sat on the client-facing side of an institutional asset manager, so you know what the function is rather than imagining it.
- You built the due diligence questionnaire portal, coordinating roughly 400 lines of answers across 20 teams. Section 9, problem 4: that is the artefact clients need in order to be able to defend a decision. You have produced the thing the client is buying.
- You handled fifty segregated market openings, which is the onboarding work that turns a won mandate into a live portfolio.
- Your Goldman spring week means you have seen this firm from inside, not from a website.

Put those together and the argument writes itself: *I have done the coordination work at the centre of this role, in this exact kind of firm, and I want to do it at the scale and with the breadth that only this platform has.*

### Why you

Your strongest asset here is not a technical skill, and trying to claim one would be a mistake. It is that the central competence of this job is **knowing the whole shelf well enough to connect the right part of it to the person in front of you**, and you can evidence that from three different directions: the shop, where you learned it without knowing it had a name; the DDQ portal, where you did it across twenty internal teams; and the market openings, where you did it across operational counterparties. That is the same skill three times, in increasingly institutional settings. Very few applicants can show the same trait in three independent contexts.

PART VI

The CEO test

## 19 Twelve questions an insider can answer

This is the mindset shift you asked for, made testable. Cover the right column and answer from memory. If you can do ten of these, you no longer sound like someone who has read about the firm.

| Question | The insider answer |
|---|---|
| What are the four ways Goldman gets paid? | Fees for advice; spread from intermediation; spread from financing; a percentage of assets managed. The first two are episodic, the last two durable. |
| What was the firm's largest single revenue line last quarter? | Management and other fees at $3,587m, with Equities financing just behind at $3,365m. Neither is dealmaking. |
| Which division loses money, how much, and why? | Platform Solutions: $95m pre-tax loss in Q3 2026, $68m across nine months, ROE −9.2%. Cause is markdowns on the Apple Card portfolio moved to held-for-sale in Q4 2025. It is the cost of exit, not of operation, and the real issue is the $3.5bn of equity trapped in it. |
| Is asset management the most profitable division? | No. It made $1,316m pre-tax at 16.1% ROE against Global Banking & Markets at $5,782m and 20.7%; over nine months the gap is 14.4% against 23.5%. AWM is less profitable per pound of equity but more durable, and durability is what lifts the firm's valuation. |
| Who uses the balance sheet? | Global Banking & Markets holds $1,940bn of $2,180bn in segment assets, about 89%. AWM uses under a tenth of the assets to make a quarter of the revenue. |
| What is the firm's actual strategy in one sentence? | Grow durable revenue (financing and fees) faster than episodic revenue (advisory and intermediation), because recurring revenue earns a higher multiple. |
| Why does the firm care more about alternatives than total AUS? | Fee rate. Alternatives grew 26% while total AUS grew 19%, so revenue grew faster than assets. Mix matters more than the headline $4.1tn. |
| How does Asset Management work with Global Markets? | As a customer, at arm's length, across five channels: execution, financing and custody, structuring, origination flow, and distribution in reverse. An information barrier separates them, and GSAM must seek best execution even when that means trading away from the firm. |
| What is the real content of One Goldman Sachs? | Coverage coordination, consolidation of competing internal teams, and cross-divisional delivery — and whether it works turns on how revenue is credited between divisions. |
| What do institutional clients actually buy? | Risk removal (LDI), a rented investment department (OCIO), access to origination they cannot replicate, defensibility to their own board, and now help with what to do about a surplus. |
| Where is Goldman not the obvious choice? | Cheap index tracking, small-scheme fiduciary management, and several individual active strategies. Its claim is breadth delivered as one relationship, not best-at-everything. |
| Which revenue line would your role feed? | Management and other fees — specifically the Asset Management half, $4,285m across the nine months. Winning or keeping an institutional mandate adds to that line directly. |

> **THE MINDSET SHIFT, STATED PLAINLY**
>
> Someone who has read about Goldman describes it by its divisions and its prestige. Someone who thinks like an owner describes it as roughly $110bn of shareholder equity that has to earn a high-teens return, allocated across businesses with different capital intensity, different volatility and different valuation multiples, in a market where the only durable asset is being trusted with the client's next decision. Both people can say "Goldman is a leading global financial institution." Only the second one can say which line of the income statement their own job would move, and by what mechanism. That is the whole difference, and you now have it.

## Sourcing and confidence

**Primary.** All firmwide and segment financials, assets under supervision, headcount, capital ratios, segment assets and geographic figures come from Goldman's Third Quarter 2026 Earnings Results of 13 October 2026 and its Form 10-Q for the quarterly period ended 30 September 2026, both of which I downloaded and read directly. The requisition fields and the division description come from a live query of Goldman's Oracle Recruiting Cloud API on 3 November 2026. Where I have computed a percentage or grouped reported lines into a category of my own, I have said so.

**Medium.** Management's quotations are from a third-party transcript of the Q3 2026 earnings call rather than from Goldman's own posting, so treat the wording as close but not certified. The alternatives fundraising targets, OCIO mandate figures, the Verizon and Lockheed appointment, the CSG sub-team list and the day-to-day reconstruction of the role come from trade press, company press releases and job postings. The 2021 analyst survey is well documented but reported figures vary between outlets.

**Low — do not state as fact.** Any London or CSG headcount. Published London estimates range from roughly 3,615 to 6,000 and clearly measure different things; none is from Goldman. The claim that hours reverted after 2021 is commentary. The $550m Abacus penalty I believe to be correct but could not re-verify today.

**Deliberately absent.** I have not estimated the size of the London Client Solutions team, the number of openings on requisition 171037, or this year's applicant numbers for it. I could not verify any of them, and a confident invented number is the one error in an interview you cannot recover from. If you need to reference scale, use the EMEA revenue and EMEA assets-under-supervision figures, which are primary and real.

**Still unresolved from earlier work.** Your June 2027 graduation date against this programme's eligibility — Summer Analyst versus New Analyst Programme — remains unverified, and it is worth settling with the recruiter.